

What a difference year made for State

EL PASO, Texas — Hello, world. This is your beloved correspondent speaking to you from the land of the sun. It is, at this very moment, 70 degrees in Sun Bowl City. Anybody for golf? At the tone, Jackson, eat your heart out.

There are, according to our generally unreliable sources, belly dancers, cheap boots and lots of illegal aliens here in the town that turned Lee Trevino loose on the PGA tour.

If you want something to eat that won't leave you looking like Martha Raye, try Wendy's or Jack-In-The-Box. If you want to see mountains, they're right over there. Yeah, right behind the bank.

There's a Chevron refinery — no town should be without one — and layers upon layers of interchanges and overpasses and — "You missed the exit again, Darlene!" — highways. El Paso is Houston without Earl Campbell.

Mississippi State's nationally 17th-ranked football team has been here since last Tuesday sightseeing and

By ORLEY HOOD



practicing for today's Sun Bowl game against Nebraska. The Bulldogs have ridden on fire engines and gone to the dog track across the border in Juarez and worked on coach Emory Bellard's beloved triple option.

"We're having a darn good time," Bellard reports.

A good time? In December?

What a difference a year makes. The 1979-model Bulldogs were the funniest act since the Marx Brothers. They were
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